

Subject:

Submission of Manuscript:

"Emergent Network Dynamics and the 9.15% Redshift Correction: A Resolutive Framework for High-Redshift Spectroscopic Anomalies"

Dear Lead Editor,

I am writing to formally submit our manuscript, "Emergent Network Dynamics and the 9.15% Redshift Correction: A Resolutive Framework for High-Redshift Spectroscopic Anomalies," for consideration for publication in The Astrophysical Journal.

This work introduces the Informational Connectivity Metric (ICM), a theoretical framework that treats the spacetime manifold as the continuum limit of a self-organizing discrete substrate with a finite capacity of $N \approx 10^{140}$. We believe this work is uniquely suited for the Galaxies and Cosmology corridor as it provides a first-principles structural resolution to two of the most pressing empirical challenges in modern astronomy:

- The Hubble Tension: We identify the 9.11% expansion discrepancy as "Temporal Inertia"—a native structural propagation lag inherent in node-to-node network updates.
- JWST High-Redshift Anomalies: The framework proposes "Topological Metric Cavitation" to explain the "top-down" precipitation of mature galaxies at $z > 14$, such as JADES-GS-z14-0, bypassing the thermodynamic limits of hierarchical accretion.

Crucially, the manuscript offers a model-independent, falsifiable prediction: a strictly positive sign for cosmological redshift drift (Sandage-Loeb effect) at $z > 2$. This provides a definitive pathway for verification using the Extremely Large Telescope (ELT).

All digital assets, including the ICM source code and formal mathematical derivations, are included in the manuscript appendix and hosted in our public repository.

Thank you for your time and consideration of this resolutive framework.

Sincerely,

Mitchell Hyde Flint

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<https://github.com/flintmitch7/Project-ICM-9.1>